

Fassoulia w Riz

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

A bowl of fassoulia with rice is the kind of meal that always feels like home.

Serves 6 · Prep 15 min · Cook 2 h 30 · + overnight

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE FASSOULIA

- 1½ cups white beans, measured after overnight soaking and draining
- 250 g faux-filet beef, cut into small cubes
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 bay leaves
- 1 tbsp paprika
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 1 tbsp ketchup
- 1 tsp chili paste
- 1 cup chicken stock
- Approximately 1–2 cups tomato juice, plus extra as needed
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper, to taste
- Water, only for soaking and initially boiling the beans

FOR THE RICE

- 1½ cups basmati rice
- Water, according to the packet instructions
- Salt, to taste

METHOD

1. Soak the beans overnight. Place the dried white beans in a large bowl and cover generously with cold water, allowing room for them to expand. Leave to soak overnight, approximately 8–12 hours.
2. Discard the soaking water. Drain and rinse the beans thoroughly. Measure 1½ cups of soaked, drained beans for this recipe.
3. Cook the beans. Place in a saucepan and cover generously with fresh water. Bring to a full boil for 10 minutes, then reduce the heat and simmer. Allow at least 1½ hours in total, and longer if needed, until fully tender. Top up with hot water as necessary, then drain.
4. Brown the beef. While the beans cook, heat the olive oil in a heavy saucepan over medium-high heat. Pat the beef dry, season lightly with salt and pepper, then brown on all sides. Transfer to a plate.
5. Soften the onion. Reduce the heat to medium. Add the diced onion to the same pan and cook for approximately 5–7 minutes, until softened.
6. Stir in the paprika, tomato paste and chili paste. Cook briefly, stirring, then add the ketchup, chicken stock and bay leaves.
7. Cook in tomato juice. Return the beef and its juices to the pan. Pour in enough tomato juice to cover the meat. Bring to a gentle simmer, cover and cook until the beef is tender. Add more tomato juice as needed to maintain the sauce.
8. Add the beans. Gently fold in the fully cooked beans. Simmer for a further 15–20 minutes, allowing them to absorb the tomato flavour. Add tomato juice if needed, or uncover to reduce the sauce if it is too loose.
9. Prepare the rice. Meanwhile, rinse the basmati rice and cook according to the packet instructions, seasoning the water lightly with salt.
10. Remove the bay leaves. Taste and adjust the seasoning, then serve hot with the rice.

Tip

Plan for the overnight soak. Always discard the soaking water, rinse and boil the beans in fresh water.

Watch Nell make it